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Unit 10: Management concepts and styles

UNIT FOCUS :

- **Reading:** Management Concepts and Styles**.**
- **Vocabulary:** Pairs, Synonyms.
- **Grammar:** Conditional Sentences.

"Effective management is all about making the right choices and ensuring your team can execute them."
(Peter Drucker)

Reading

Read the Text. Underline the New Words.

A **manager [1]** needs to understand a few simple ideas to employ the five basic operations. These concepts are essential to ensure their team comes together to reach the business' goals:

Control [2]: Employees of an organization need to understand the goals that they are aiming for as well as the **measurement [3]** that will be used to determine whether they have been successful. Different staff members in a company have different roles that entail separate levels of **responsibility [4]**. A manager must have control over what the members do, how they do it and how to measure their progress. Control over these factors helps a manager reach success.

Planning [5]: The best managers know that planning is critical before the **implementation [6]** of any strategy, but it is also an **ongoing activity [30]**. Planning does not end when implementation begins. Rather, management needs to be prepared to answer the questions of who, what, when and where a team is working to implement the organization's **mission [7]**. Planning should include selecting **objectives [8]** as well as implementing them.

Staffing [9]: Staffing is an underappreciated but crucial function of management. Managers need to ensure that they have the right people for the job, but they also need to pay attention to issues like organizing **workplace policies [10]**. The company needs to **retain [11]** the best talent by providing **incentives [12]** such as benefits, paid time off and a thorough **training program [13]**.

Analysts who study management have identified several effective **leadership styles [14]**. There is no one best style of management and some people will feel more personally suited to one

type or another. You can also select elements of different styles of management to create the best **archetype [15]** for you and your company.

Here, we briefly review three positive management styles that can help make any manager a more effective leader.

Persuasive management style [16] A **compelling leader [17]** spends a lot of time with their team members. Being engaged with employees allows the persuasive manager to **lead by example [18]**, and to gain **buy-in [19]** and **compliance [20]** from the team by persuading rather than instructing or demanding. Influential managers are aware of the work that their team members are doing on a day-to-day basis and are involved in their work lives.

Democratic management style [21] A democratic manager invites the team to be directly involved in decision-making. **Open lines of communication [22]** between democratic managers and employees allow these types of managers to understand the skills and advantages that each employee brings to the table. Open participation and **exchange of ideas [23]** among different levels of employees allow everyone to contribute to the outcome of a decision or a project.

This style of management is more successful when managers develop organized and **streamlined processes [24]** (decision-making processes). Otherwise, accepting input from everyone can make the process sluggish and disorganized.

Laissez-faire management [25] the laissez-faire manager functions almost more like a **mentor [26]** than a manager. They **empower [27]** their employees to step up and make decisions. This allows the team to feel like they own a part of each project. The manager takes a **backseat role [28]**, stepping in to offer advice or get things back on track when something goes wrong. Otherwise, they stand aside, allowing their employees to **flourish creatively [29]** and exercise their own leadership.

(From *Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia*)

Glossary

1	**Manager**	A leader responsible for employing operations and guiding a team to reach business goals.
2	**Control**	The management function of understanding goals, measuring success, and overseeing member responsibility.
3	**Measurement**	The standard or method used to determine if a goal has been successfully achieved.
4	**Responsibility**	Specific duties and accountability assigned to different staff members based on their roles.
5	**Planning**	A critical, ongoing activity of determining strategies, objectives, and logistics (who, what, when, where) before implementation.
6	**Implementation**	The process of putting a decision, strategy, or plan into effect.

7	**Mission**	The core purpose or main objective of an organization that the team works to implement.
8	**Objectives**	Specific goals selected during the planning phase to be achieved.
9	**Staffing**	The function of recruiting the right people, organizing policies, and retaining talent.
10	**Workplace Policies**	Organizational rules and guidelines managed under the staffing function.
11	**Retain**	To keep good employees within the company rather than losing them to competitors.
12	**Incentives**	Rewards (like benefits or paid time off) provided to employees to encourage them to stay and perform well.
13	**Training Program**	An educational process provided by the company to improve employee skills.
14	**Leadership Styles**	Different approaches or methods a manager uses to lead a team (e.g., Persuasive, Democratic).
15	**Archetype**	A model or perfect example of a management style created by combining elements that suit the manager.
16	**Persuasive Management**	A style where the leader engages with the team and convinces them rather than demanding compliance.
17	**Compelling Leader**	A leader who leads by example and is deeply involved in the team's work life.
18	**Lead by Example**	Guiding a team by modeling the behavior and work ethic expected of them.
19	**Buy-in**	Acceptance of and agreement with a decision or direction by the team members.
20	**Compliance**	The act of adhering to rules or requests, gained through persuasion in this context.
21	**Democratic Management**	A style where the manager invites the team to be directly involved in decision-making.
22	**Open Lines of Communication**	A transparent flow of information that allows managers to understand employee skills.
23	**Exchange of Ideas**	The sharing of thoughts and suggestions among different levels of employees.
24	**Streamlined Processes**	Organized and efficient methods of decision-making designed to prevent sluggishness.
25	**Laissez-faire Management**	A hands-off style where the manager functions more like a mentor than a boss.
26	**Mentor**	A trusted advisor role taken by a laissez-faire manager to offer guidance rather than strict control.
27	**Empower**	To give employees the authority and confidence to make their own decisions.

28	**Backseat Role**	When a manager stands aside and lets the team lead, only stepping in when necessary.
29	**Creative Flourishing**	The result of allowing employees freedom to exercise their own leadership and ideas.

Digest what you read

A. Based on the information given in the text, select True, False, or Not Given.

.....1- Control involves measuring employee progress towards goals.
.....2- Planning ends as soon as a strategy's implementation begins.
.....3- Staffing includes providing incentives to retain talent.
.....4- The persuasive management style relies on giving strict orders.
.....5- A democratic manager makes all decisions alone.

B. Select the best answer for the items below. Refer to the text to check your answers.

1. **What is a key aspect of the control function?**
   A. Hiring new employees.
   B. Measuring progress and ensuring goals are met.
   C. Developing company-wide policy.
   D. Organizing social events for staff.

2. **According to the text, what does planning involve?**
   A. Only selecting objectives.
   B. Only implementing strategies.
   C. Selecting objectives and implementing them.
   D. Replacing team members.

3. **How does a laissez-faire manager typically act?**
   A. Like a strict commander.
   B. Like a mentor who empowers the team.
   C. By making all decisions democratically.
   D. By persuading employees with constant oversight.

4. **Which management style is most threatened by a disorganized decision-making process?**
   A. Persuasive
   B. Democratic
   C. Laissez-Faire
   D. All of them

5. **What is the main goal of providing incentives?**
   A. To increase control over employees.
   B. To retain the best talent in the company.
   C. To reduce the need for training.
   D. To implement strategies faster.

Vocabulary Loading

A. Using the words given in Box 1, find definitions from Box 2.

Box 1	Box 2
1. Control	A) A reward or benefit used to motivate people.
2. Planning	B) The process of finding and hiring the right people for jobs.
3. Staffing	C) The power to influence or direct people's behavior or the course of events.
4. Incentive	D) Giving someone the authority or power to do something.
5. Empowerment	E) The process of making plans for something.
6. Compliance	F) The action of following orders or requests.
7. Decision-making	G) The process of making important choices.

B. Find matching pairs. Translate them into Arabic.

Part 1	Part 2	Pairs	Translation (Arabic)
Business	goals	Business goals	أهداف العمل/الأعمال
Workplace	making		
Decision	policies		
Training	program		
Leadership	styles		
Team	members		
Strategic	objectives		
Employee	progress		
Open	communication		
Creative	empowerment		

C. Fill in the blanks using the proper words from the previous section.

1. A good manager must have _____ over the team's activities to ensure success.
2. The company introduced a new _____ to improve employee skills.
3. _____ is the process of selecting the best course of action among alternatives.
4. Offering bonuses is a common _____ to boost productivity.
5. _____ between managers and employees is essential for a democratic style.

D. Enhancing Your Vocabulary

Match the words on the left with their synonyms on the right.

1. Crucial | a) Keep
2. Retain | b) Vital
3. Ensure | c) Give power to
4. Empower | d) Guarantee
5. Implement | e) Execute

Grammar Injection

Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the verbs from the reading.

Understand, Measure, Select, Retain, Involve, Empower, Achieve, Provide, Gain, Foster

1. Employees need to _____ the goals they are aiming for.
2. A manager must _____ progress to ensure success.
3. Planning includes _____ objectives and implementing them.
4. Companies must _____ the best talent by providing incentives.
5. A democratic manager _____ the team in decision-making.
6. A laissez-faire manager _____ employees to make decisions.
7. The primary aim is to _____ business goals.
8. Managers _____ incentives like benefits and paid time off.
9. A persuasive leader aims to _____ buy-in from the team.
10. This approach helps _____ a sense of ownership among employees.

Grammar Handling

Conditional Sentences

Conditional sentences are used to talk about hypothetical situations and their consequences. They often contain the word "if" and are essential for discussing plans, strategies, and potential outcomes in management.

There are several types of conditional sentences. We will focus on two main types:

1. Zero Conditional

- **Use:** For general truths, facts, and situations that are always true.
- **Structure:** If/When + Present Simple, ... Present Simple
- **Example: If a manager empowers his team,** creativity *increases*.
- **Example: When employees understand the goals,** they *perform* better.

2. First Conditional

- **Use:** For real and possible situations in the future.
- **Structure:** If + Present Simple, ... will + base verb
- **Example: If we implement this strategy,** we **will achieve** our objectives.
- **Example: If the manager doesn't provide clear feedback,** the team **will not improve**.

Practice:

Complete the following sentences using the Zero or First Conditional.

1. If a manager uses a persuasive style, he or she _____ (spend) a lot of time with the team.
2. If the company offers good benefits, it _____ (retain) its best employees.
3. When a manager has good control, the team usually _____ (meet) its targets.
4. If we don't plan carefully, we _____ (not succeed) in our mission.
5. When employees are involved in decision-making, they _____ (feel) a greater sense of ownership.

Translate the text into Arabic.

A democratic manager invites the team to be directly involved in decision-making. Open lines of communication between democratic managers and employees allow these types of managers to understand the skills and advantages that each employee brings to the table. Open participation and exchange of ideas among different levels of employees allow everyone to contribute to the outcome of a decision or a project. This style of management is more successful when managers develop organized and streamlined decision-making processes.

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Self-check: Check your progress in this unit. Tick (√) the statements which are true about you.

• I can explain key management concepts like control, planning, and staffing.

• I can describe different management styles.

• I have learned more than 20 new words from this unit.

• I understand how to use Zero and First Conditional sentences.

• This unit helped me understand my technical subject better.